CCIR · COMPUTE CREDIT INDEX RESEARCH

Benchmark Change Management and Versioning Policy

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Administrator	CCIR Compute Credit Index Research
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Methodology	v1.0.0 (March 2026)
IOSCO Basis	Principle 12 — Changes to Benchmark Methodology
Document Status	Active

This document establishes CCIR's policy for managing changes to the Compute Rate Index (CRI) methodology, index scope, data sources, and governance framework. It defines how changes are classified, what advance notice is required, how stakeholders are informed, and how historical values are preserved across versions.

Credit agreements that cite CRI rates by name require certainty that the rates they reference will not be materially altered without adequate notice. This policy provides that certainty. It reflects IOSCO Principle 12 (Changes to Benchmark Methodology) and is informed by post-LIBOR market practice, which has established advance notice and stakeholder consultation as non-negotiable elements of benchmark governance.

1. Scope

This policy applies to all changes to:

- Eligibility filters or thresholds applied at the Silver layer
- Computation method, aggregation approach, or rolling window length
- Data sources contributing to any published index
- Index series scope (addition, retirement, or renaming of any CRI index)
- Confidence flag definitions or threshold values
- Collection schedule or pipeline architecture where it affects published rates
- Geographic scope or normalization methodology
- Governance framework, including Oversight Board composition or mandate

This policy does not apply to: routine infrastructure maintenance, credential rotation, monitoring improvements, or audit framework enhancements that do not affect published index values.

2. Change Classification

All methodology changes are classified into one of three tiers based on their potential impact on published index values and the interests of parties who have cited CRI rates in credit documents.

Tier	Version Bump	Notice Period	Examples
Patch	x.x.0 → x.x.1	5 business days — notice only	GPU model string correction; collection logic fix that does not alter published rates; new model variant added to existing index

Minor	x.0.x → x.1.0	30 calendar days — notice + comment	Source addition or removal; Silver filter threshold adjustment; confidence flag definition change; new index series added; cluster tier addition
Major	1.x.x → 2.0.0	90 calendar days — notice + consultation period + published response	Computation method change (e.g. flat median to time-weighted); window length change; unit change (e.g. per-GPU-hr to performance-based); index retirement; geographic scope change

2.1 Patch Changes

Patch changes correct errors, update data source model string mappings, or add new GPU model variants to existing indices without altering the computation logic. A patch change does not alter published rates in any material direction. Patch changes are effective 5 business days after notice is posted to the CCIR methodology changelog on ccir.io.

2.2 Minor Changes

Minor changes modify eligibility criteria, add or remove data sources, adjust confidence flag thresholds, or add new index series. Minor changes may affect the level of published rates — a new source addition, for example, could shift the median if the new source prices differently from existing sources. Thirty calendar days advance notice is required. A comment period runs for the full notice period. CCIR will publish a summary response to material comments received before the change takes effect.

2.3 Major Changes

Major changes alter the fundamental structure of the benchmark: computation method, window length, unit of measurement, or index retirement. Major changes require 90 calendar days advance notice, a formal public consultation period, and a published response to stakeholder comments before implementation. Where a major change retires an existing index, CCIR will run the old and new series in parallel for a minimum of 60 days to support transition in existing credit agreements.

Parties with existing credit agreements citing CRI rates at the time a major change is announced may contact research@ccir.io to discuss transition arrangements. CCIR will make reasonable efforts to support orderly transition, including providing historical data under both old and new methodologies for the parallel-run period.

3. Versioning Framework

CCIR uses semantic versioning (MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH) for the methodology. The current version is v1.0.0.

- MAJOR version increments for major changes (e.g. v1.x.x → v2.0.0). Existing credit agreements citing v1.x.x continue to reference the v1.x.x published rate series, which CCIR will maintain in parallel for a minimum of 60 days following the v2.0.0 effective date.
- MINOR version increments for minor changes (e.g. v1.0.x → v1.1.0).
- PATCH version increments for patch changes (e.g. v1.0.0 → v1.0.1).

The methodology version is stamped on every Bronze, Silver, and Gold row in the pipeline. Any published index value can be matched to the specific methodology version that governed its computation. This creates a permanent, queryable record linking published rates to the governance framework in effect at the time of publication.

Historical index values are never restated under a new methodology version. If a computation error is identified in a prior version, the correction is applied prospectively from the patch effective date. The corrected values are published alongside the original values for the period between error discovery and correction, with clear disclosure.

4. Notification Procedures

The table below summarizes the notification channels and requirements for each change tier.

Change Tier	ccir.io Publication	research@ccir.io Notification	GitHub Repo Notice
Patch	Notice posted to methodology changelog	Not required	CHANGELOG.md entry; methodology version tag in pipeline
Minor	30-day advance notice posted; comment window open	Email to registered contacts	CHANGELOG.md entry; version bump on all pipeline rows
Major	90-day advance notice; public comment period; published response to comments	Direct outreach to known credit agreement counterparties	CHANGELOG.md; parallel publication of old and new series during transition

All change notices will include: (a) the proposed change described in plain language; (b) the rationale for the change; (c) the proposed effective date; (d) the anticipated impact on published index values; and (e) instructions for submitting comments to research@ccir.io.

Comments received during the notice period are logged and reviewed. For minor and major changes, CCIR will publish a written response summarizing the comments received and explaining how each was addressed before the change takes effect. No comment is required to implement a patch change.

5. Historical Data Preservation

CCIR commits to the following historical data preservation standards, which are relevant to parties with existing credit agreements and to rating agency analysts reviewing benchmark history for stress calibration.

- Published CSV files for all active and retired CRI indices remain accessible at their original GitHub paths permanently. Retired index files are not deleted; they are marked as retired in the methodology changelog.
- Delta Lake Bronze tables are append-only and are retained indefinitely. Every published index value can be traced to the specific API collection events that generated it via SHA-256 snapshot hashes.
- The methodology version stamped on each Gold row allows any historical value to be matched to the governance document and eligibility filters in effect at the time of publication.
- Upon request from a party with a credit agreement citing CRI rates, CCIR will provide historical index data in standard CSV format at no charge for purposes of covenant compliance verification.

6. Index Retirement and Cessation Policy

Index retirement is a major change requiring 90 calendar days advance notice and a consultation period. CCIR will not retire an index without this notice period except in the event of a Force Majeure Cessation (defined below).

6.1 Planned Retirement

Planned retirement occurs when CCIR determines that an index no longer represents an active, relevant market — for example, if a GPU model generation is no longer commercially deployed. The retirement process includes: 90-day advance notice, parallel publication of a successor index where applicable, and permanent archival of the retired index's historical values at their original publication path.

6.2 Force Majeure Cessation

A Force Majeure Cessation occurs if CCIR is unable to publish a CRI rate due to: loss of access to all qualifying data sources for a given model for more than 10 consecutive business days; or a legal or regulatory order requiring cessation of publication. In a Force Majeure Cessation, CCIR will publish notice as promptly as practicable and will provide the most recent available index value along with the date of the last valid publication.

Credit agreements referencing CRI rates should include fallback provisions addressing Force Majeure Cessation. CCIR does not prescribe fallback language — this is the responsibility of structured finance counsel — but recommends that fallback provisions address: (a) the fallback rate (e.g., last published CRI value, lender-determined equivalent, or alternative benchmark); (b) the trigger event (consecutive days of non-publication); and (c) the party responsible for determining the fallback rate.

7. Governance Interaction

Until the CCIR Oversight Board is formed (targeted Q1 2027), change classification decisions are made by the CCIR administrator. Upon Oversight Board formation, the Board will review all proposed minor and major changes before the notice period commences. The Board's role is to assess whether the proposed change is consistent with CCIR's methodology principles, adequately supported by data, and appropriately disclosed to stakeholders.

Patch changes do not require Oversight Board approval. The Board will receive a summary of all patch changes at its next scheduled meeting following implementation.

8. Document Control

Version	1.0
Date	March 2026
Supersedes	N/A — initial issuance
Next Review	March 2027, or upon material governance change
Administrator	CCIR Compute Credit Index Research
Contact	research@ccir.io